MONTHLY UPDATE

Public debate and participation in policymaking: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *22 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.*

CENTRAL AFRICAN REPUBLIC · CHAD · EQUATORIAL GUINEA · ETHIOPIA · GABON · GHANA · GUINEA · KENYA · LIBERIA · MALI · MOROCCO · NIGER · SENEGAL · SOMALIA · SOUTH AFRICA · SOUTH SUDAN · TANZANIA · TOGO · TUNISIA · UGANDA · ZAMBIA · ZIMBABWE

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Central African Republic

The government gave itself a unit to watch public debate. A presidential decree created a communication-monitoring cell under the government spokesperson, with a permanent secretariat and three units, one dedicated to crisis communication, to monitoring national and international media and social networks, and to countering rumours. Its staff are to be appointed by decree in Council of Ministers. The decree as reported sets no safeguard on how the monitoring is used, and no budget is published.

Chad

A report by two research organisations documents 44 fabricated identities — 35 ghost journalists and nine fake experts — placed in African media between 2021 and 2026, which it links to Russian influence operations. The report itself is not held, only a Chadian newspaper's account of it, and no Chadian outlet, byline or piece is named in what is held.

The Lac restriction is nearly two years old. A citizen's open letter to the president asks for the province's internet access to be reviewed; no official justification is on record.

Equatorial Guinea

Two enforcement bodies agreed to exchange information rather than to publish any. The attorney general's office and the national anti-corruption commission agreed a permanent coordination mechanism on 3 September: institutional liaison points for continuous contact, an information-exchange protocol and periodic reviews. No protocol text, data categories, safeguards or first review date is published, and neither body publishes a caseload against which any of it could be read.

Ethiopia

Internet and telephone services were severely disrupted across Tigray as fighting escalated, reported on 26 September 2026: the state operator's services were down and the second operator's partly running. An internet observatory confirmed a regional disruption; the regional and federal authorities each blame the other.

Gabon

The presidential spokesman said on radio that he uses a virtual private network to get round the social-media suspension, which was reported still in force.

Ghana

On 13 September a senior nursing officer was arrested and then charged with abetting the publication of false news under section 208 of the Criminal Offences Act and remanded without bail, over videos from a UK-based TikTok account; rights lawyers have put the detention and the evidence-gathering as constitutional questions, and the case returns to court on 30 September.

On 22 September the Secretary to the President asked the Media Foundation for West Africa and the Ghana Journalists Association to convene a national stakeholder engagement and draft a roadmap on hate speech and harmful online content, including guidance for law enforcement and alternatives to arrest and prosecution for speech that is not criminal. The letter cautions that arrests over criticism out of proportion to the conduct may be counterproductive, and sets no deadline.

Guinea

The communication authority banned France 24 with immediate effect on 17 September on every vector, satellite, cable, mobile applications, websites and social networks, withdrew its correspondents' accreditation and requisitioned the telecommunications regulator to enforce the ban, citing an offence to the President.

On 21 September the same authority banned ten web TV channels, among them Dabola TV, Coyah TV and Siguiri 24 Star TV, and two news sites for audiovisual activity online without prior authorisation, across the national territory and on all digital platforms.

Kenya

The Digital Superhighway's procurement went to court and lost. On 4 September the High Court quashed the 2024 advisory opinion of the Attorney-General that had cleared payments connected to the Sh15bn Nightigale tender, and referred the conflict-of-interest question to the anti-corruption commission. The challenge came from a consumer federation, which had contested the award of two 2022-23 tenders and the payment made to the communications regulator's former chairperson on the strength of that opinion. The judgment itself is not held, and no response from the agencies or the Attorney-General is on file — but the opinion that stood behind the payments no longer does.

Liberia

Ten civil society organisations signed a founding memorandum for a Digital Advocacy and Rights Alliance, reported on 24 September, committing to press for an independent data protection authority, amendments narrowing the Cybercrime Act, tighter oversight of state interception, and judicial authorisation and public reporting for any internet shutdown. Its founding assembly is due within 90 days of the last signature.

Mali

The cybercrime tribunal sentenced the publication director of Le Témoin to two years in prison on 14 September, over a remark about Kidal made on television in June; the defence intends to appeal.

Morocco

A party's election manifesto proposes that administrative silence count as approval, that prior authorisations be reduced, and that artificial intelligence be used in the governance of public policy. It binds nobody unless the party forms a government, and no bill, scope, exempted-decision list or timetable exists.

The spyware allegations were argued rather than adjudicated. Two Moroccan commentaries on 8 September set out the domestic case: an academic and politician rejected as overstated the July 2026 consortium findings tying Moroccan bodies to the compromise of the Spanish prime minister's phone, and a separate press analysis asked whether the Spanish courts will reopen a related file — neither the findings nor any court filing is held here, and the repository establishes nothing about the underlying allegation either way.

Niger

A state observatory monitored the country's media and platforms through a security incident and then told the media owners what it found. The national communication observatory monitored traditional media, online media and the main publicly accessible digital platforms from 28 August to 1 September and presented its conclusions in Niamey on 2 September, reporting exceptional information intensity in the hours after shots and explosions were reported near an air base at the international airport, the effects of an information vacuum, divergence in how the facts were characterised, and social networks accelerating both information and disinformation with old images and out-of-context video circulated. Its president said the meeting was not a trial of the media. The monitoring report itself is not published, so what was measured, over what sample and under what legal basis is not established.

Senegal

Where a mast is put became a parliamentary question. A member of the National Assembly addressed written questions to several ministers over the proliferation of telecommunications masts sited close to residential areas, seeking clarification of the conditions under which they are installed. The questions are put and not answered, and the repository holds no siting rule, exposure standard or regulator position against which to read them.

Somalia

The state gave a number for what it removes from the internet. On 3 September the information ministry's director general said the federal government had closed 82,000 social media pages during 2026 that it alleges carried armed-group propaganda, across Facebook, TikTok and Telegram, with the count still rising, placing the removals as the ideological front of a counter-terrorism strategy alongside its military and economic ones. The count, the platforms and the attribution are the ministry's; no legal basis, appeal route, oversight mechanism or platform confirmation was stated.

South Africa

A joint report on harmful online content, launched on 18 September, finds the statutory framework adequate but its governance fragmented, and content moderation conducted in English to the exclusion of ten official languages.

South Sudan

Participants at a rights forum reported on 2 September said the revenue authority has not consistently published the revenue-collection information it is required to, and that the body responsible for access to information lacks the staff to enforce the law.

Tanzania

An activist and social-media influencer filed a complaint against a platform company in a California court on 21 August 2026, alleging that her accounts were disabled at the direction of the government.

Togo

The national internet governance forum, run annually since 2010, held its twelfth edition on 19 June, with the digital regulators on its panels alongside civil society. CIVICUS rates civic space Repressed at 29 of 100, the rating held since 2020.

Tunisia

Parliament's case file on the bill revising the 2022 cyber-offences decree-law records it deposited on 20 February 2024, referred to committee on 10 April 2025, carries 38 sponsors and has not been voted; its operative text is not published on the assembly's page. On 29 September the Council of Ministers deliberated a draft decree amending Decree-Law 54; its content was not published.

Uganda

The revenue authority told manufacturers on 11 September 2026 that its e-Tax2 platform has been in build since February 2026, web-only and keyed on national identification and business registration numbers. The award remains set aside by the Appeals Tribunal; the two accounts are not reconciled.

Zambia

The criminal route for online speech was used. A Lusaka magistrate convicted a vlogger on 11 September under section 54 of the Cyber Security and Cyber Crimes Act 2021 for forwarding a WhatsApp screenshot about a presidential aide.

A second case followed the next day: a tailor in Mansa was arrested under the cyber crimes statute over a TikTok video insulting the president.

The section 54 case ended in custody: the vlogger was sentenced to nine months on 15 September for forwarding a screenshot.

Zimbabwe

Planning moved a generation further out. The ICT ministry's permanent secretary was appointed to the parliamentary body planning a thirty-year national roadmap to 2056, which the ministry presents as putting the sector at the centre of long-term national planning. No terms of reference, membership list, work programme or output for the committee is held, and the roadmap itself does not yet exist - so what is established is a seat at a table, not a plan.

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